



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Hope Academy
School Website: <https://hopeschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Hope Academy (Minneapolis, MN, 55404-3834) presents a robust, clearly articulated classical-Christian model of education rooted in a theology-driven, virtue-formation framework. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a Christ-centered, God-centered approach that treats truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. The curriculum foregrounds liberal arts, Great Books, Latin/Greek study, and a classical pedagogy that blends contemplative/ memory-based lower-school practices with Socratic dialogue, seminars, and rhetoric-focused upper-school work. Parental involvement and community partnership are positioned as foundational to the school's identity, with explicit practices described for family engagement, home-school collaboration, and shared formation of character.

Overall classification across the six classical-education criteria: CLASSICAL. Evidence from Hope Academy's public materials aligns with the six-element rubric across all categories—Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; and Parents & Community. Key textual anchors include: God-centered and Bible-centered formation; daily worship and chapel; Great Books, liberal arts, Latin/Greek; Socratic seminars and rhetorical training; teachers described as the "living curriculum" and mentors; and explicit parental involvement as a core expectation. See supporting sources cited in-line below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe Hope Academy as Christ-centered with Scripture at the center of all knowledge, including daily worship, Bible and prayer times, and weekly Chapel in Upper School. The Bible teaches that all knowledge comes from God, and education is grounded in God's truth (The Philosophy of Education section).
- The school explicitly states a "Classical Model" that embraces a tradition of classical education focusing on truth, goodness, and beauty; the curriculum is "informed by God's Word" and covenantal worship is integrated into daily life.
- Statements about "Education in Glory" (truth, goodness, beauty) and "Classical Curriculum" with focus on the Great Books, literature, and the arts appear in the "elements of classical education" material.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keyword indicators present: God-centered, Christ-centered, Scripture, Bible, worship, daily chapel, truth, goodness, beauty, great books, classical model, education in glory, formation in virtue, moral imagination, living curriculum, teacher as mentor.

- Negative keyword indicators present: None detected in the public-facing materials (no explicit claims or language aligning with the “Lack of Partnership with Families” or other negative indicators from the classical rubric).

Why this rating

- The materials consistently anchor education in the realities of God and transcendentals, with liturgical practices (worship, Bible study, chapel) and explicit theology-integration across curricula. This directly matches the Positive Keywords framework for a robust religious/metaphysical foundation and aligns with the classical school rubric’s expectations. The presence of daily worship, Bible-centered curriculum, and a theology-grounded view of knowledge strongly supports CLASSICAL rather than a more secular or neutral stance. The explicit mention of “Christ-Centered” and “God-centered” content is demonstrative of a fully Classical foundation in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes formation of character and virtue, not merely information or job preparation. The Philosophy of Education and Distinctives highlight formation in truth, good, and beauty within a classical framework; the mission centers on forming students who know and love God and who grow in character and leadership.
- Statements such as “We aim to help each student discover their God-given value and purpose” and the “remarkable education” narrative frame education as formation of humanity and virtue, consistent with purpose-driven, virtue-oriented goals.
- The school’s Distinctives articulate a classical model that emphasizes the liberal arts, great books, and a holistic formation—consistent with the classic aim of cultivating wisdom and virtue rather than sole job preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keyword indicators present: virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, beauty, goodness, character, moral imagination, love of learning, formation of affections, the good, contemplative learning, great books, classical model.
- Negative keyword indicators present: None detected.

Why this rating

- The public materials frame education as formation of virtue and wisdom, rooted in transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and anchored in a Christian worldview. The goals described — character formation, intellectual virtue, and a life oriented toward God — map directly to the rubric’s category for purpose and goal, yielding CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is described as liberal-arts-centered with grammar, logic, and rhetoric, and includes study of the Great Books and a classical curriculum approach. Materials mention Latin and Greek, the Great Books, and a four-part structure around formation through the liberal arts.
- There is explicit reference to “the liberal arts” and “the great books,” and to a curriculum designed to foster wonder and deep study of creation, literature, and the arts. The materials state that students study the Great Books and engage in the Great Conversation.
- The upper- and lower-school materials describe a progression from Biblical/Greek Bible study and leadership in middle school to college-preparatory, humane letters and rhetoric in high school, with a center on forming thinking through classical disciplines.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis



- Positive keyword indicators present: Great Books, liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric (three liberal arts), Latin/Greek, history woven through curriculum, formation, wonder, education in glory, classical curriculum, Socratic seminars.
- Negative keyword indicators present: None detected.

Why this rating

- The program explicitly centers on classical-curriculum elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric), heavy emphasis on Great Books and liberal arts, and a history-integrated, wonder-focused pedagogy. The textual evidence aligns strongly with the “Curriculum” criteria of a classical education, supporting CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogy includes contemplative/restful elements and memory-friendly practices in lower grades (singing, chanting, repetition) and Socratic/seminar-based, rhetoric-focused activities in upper grades. The public materials explicitly mention Rhymes, songs, imitation, and Socratic seminars.
- There is explicit reference to upper-school Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, and to lower-school singing and memorization as part of pedagogy.
- The “Methods of Instruction” and “Education in Glory” components of the classical model further articulate a pedagogy that blends contemplation with rigorous inquiry.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keyword indicators present: contemplative education, memory-ritual (singing/chanting), Socratic seminars, rhetoric training, great books, teacher-as-mentors, living curriculum, inquiry-based dialogue.
- Negative keyword indicators present: None detected.

Why this rating

- The site clearly describes a pedagogy that uses both contemplative/memory-based lower-school activities and Socratic, seminar-based, interrogation-driven upper-school pedagogy, plus explicit rhetoric instruction. This matches the rubric’s expectations for a classical pedagogy and yields CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school promotes teachers as “living curriculum” and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; teachers are described as the core of the school and as living embodiments of the mission.
- Materials describe a partnership with families and a high standard for faculty performance; there are explicit references to faculty being examined against a defined model of a teacher and student.
- There is a focus on personal relationships between teachers and students, and the teachers are described as “remarkable” and central to student growth; this aligns with the classical rubric’s “living curriculum” concept.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keyword indicators present: living curriculum; teachers as mentors; model teachers; teacher-student relationship; high standards; personal relationships; teacher as core of school.
- Negative keyword indicators present: None detected.

Why this rating

- The materials consistently frame faculty as central, virtuous models who embody the curriculum and facilitate formation. This aligns with the CLASSICAL rubric’s expectation for a strong, virtuous, mentor-based faculty and yields CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Parental involvement is a core distinctive of the school; there are explicit statements about parental involvement, home visits, parent conferences, volunteering, and family events; parents are described as co-teachers and co-educators.
- Materials describe a partnership with families, parent workshops, and resources to strengthen families, emphasizing that parents are integral to the educational process and are welcomed for visits and engagement.
- The school notes that seven family events, Parent Involvement Day, and other family-focused activities are baked into the school culture; it frames education as a shared mission with families.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keyword indicators present: partnership with families; parental involvement; parent as co-educator; home visits; family events; parent training/resources; school-family synergy.
- Negative keyword indicators present: None detected.

Why this rating

- Given explicit emphasis on family partnership, parent involvement as co-educators, and visible family-engagement practices, the category aligns strongly with the classical rubric's Community/Parents criterion, yielding CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment

- All six categories are CLASSICAL according to the keyword-anchored rubric. The set of public materials from Hope Academy (Minneapolis, MN, 55404-3834) demonstrates a consistent classical-Christian orientation, with explicit focus on God-centered formation, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal arts and Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, the living-curriculum faculty, and active parental partnership.

What would move the needle

- Not required. No major needle-moving changes are indicated as necessary, given the CLASSICAL standing across all six categories.
- If desired, minor enhancements could include deeper explicit articulation of accountability metrics tied to virtue formation (without departing from the classical framework) or expanded public-facing details on how Great Conversations and Great Books are integrated across more grade levels to reinforce the Great Conversation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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